



dominates the northern part of the continent. Despite its natural resources, Africa has had more than its fair share of problems. For years, Europeans colonized it, plundering the continent for their own gain. Since then,

Africa has had to contend with wars, natural disasters, crippling debt, and AIDS. It is home to many of the poorest countries in the world. Despite its troubles, Africans are determinedly working toward a better future.

African statistics



LANGUAGES

Arabic and its dialects are Africa's most popular language. Lots of other languages are spoken by just a few thousand people each.

Arabic	112 million
Yoruba	20 million
Amharic	17.4 million
Igbo	17 million



RELIGIONS

In Africa it is very common for people to follow both a major world religion and to practice a local African religion.

Christian	373 million
Muslim	319 million
African religions	585 million
Other	8 million



URBAN POPULATION

Only 30 percent of Africans live in cities. Urban areas and their shanty town areas are growing rapidly due to migration.

Cairo	16 million
Lagos	13.5 million
Nairobi	6 million
Kinshasa	5 million



POPULATION BY COUNTRY

Nigeria has the greatest population in Africa. However, the tiny island of Mauritius is the most densely populated country.

Nigeria	127 million
Egypt	70 million
Ethiopia	66 million
D.R.Congo	54 million

AFRICAN FACTS

PLACES

Number of countries	53 +dependencies
Highest point	Kilimanjaro, Tanzania 19,340 ft (5,895 m)
Longest river	Nile River 4,145 miles (6,671 km)
Biggest lake	Lake Victoria 26,293 sq miles (68,100 sq km)
Biggest country	Sudan
Smallest country on Africa mainland	Gambia

PEOPLE

Population of continent	778 million
Male life expectancy	51 years
Female life expectancy	54 years

LITERACY RATE

Male	65%
Female	42%

POPULATION

Africa's population is growing fast. The densest populations are round the edges of the continent away from the parched, scorching Sahara desert that cuts across the continent, and the Kalahari and Namib deserts in the south.

The lush, thick rain forests of central Africa are only lightly populated.

Population density (people per sq km)

below 50
50 - 99
100 - 149
150 - 199
200 - 299
above 300

